

RHYTHM RPG

Understand the combat system

A plain-language player and design guide

Four abilities. As many passives as you earn.

Your rhythm performance produces resources. Your build decides how to use them: protect yourself, recover, set up a reaction, or turn that preparation into damage.

Includes all **35 abilities, 38 passives, 9 upgrades and 15 sample builds**, with the latest rhythm connections and the game's existing systems explained together.

Based on local project documentation

2 October 2026 | Balance values are starting points for playtesting.

Reading map

Read the explanations first. Use the catalogs when you want a specific cost, effect, or passive level.

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1. What you do in a fight

The battle alternates between defending a rhythm sequence and performing one chosen ability.

Step	Your job
1. Enemy turn	Play the enemy rhythm chart. Better judgements reduce pressure and can earn counters, reflection, mana or shield through your build.
2. Player turn begins	Resources and cooldowns update. Check your health, mana, counters, shield and the enemy's marks.
3. Choose one ability	Pick one of four equipped actions. If it offers a choice, decide before paying its cost.
4. Play its chart	The quality of your timing affects damage, healing and protection. Some rewards depend on a phrase or a completed special note.
5. Effects resolve	The action and eligible passives apply. The next enemy turn starts unless someone has been defeated.

Four slots are your four tools

Healing and buffing use the same action as attacking. Having more mana never gives you an extra ability selection in that turn. A passive works automatically and does not need an ability slot.

Keep an affordable action

Strike and Siphon cost 0 MP and have no cooldown. Keeping one avoids waiting helplessly when your costly tools are unavailable. Tremor and Gale Step also cost 0 MP, but have cooldowns.

The normal new run starts with **Blank Slate**: Strike, Mend, two empty slots, and no passives. Rewards gradually turn it into a build. An enemy can also die during its own turn from reflection or a Burn tick.

2. Why the rhythm matters

Good timing changes both the strength of an action and the resources you can carry into later decisions.

Judgement	Ability score
Perfect	100%
Good	80%
Bad	50%
Miss	0%

An ability normally uses the average of these scores. If its damage is 50 and your chart averages 80%, it deals about 40 before other bonuses and enemy resistance. This is the ability calculation; enemy note damage follows the defense rules.

A phrase is one musical bar

A completed phrase succeeds at **70% or better**. Four Good notes average 80%, so you do not need every note to be Perfect. One musical bar can reward a steady passage, rather than only a single flawless hit.

Rhythm achievement	What can reward it
Successful defense phrase	Counter Preparation stores a charge within its turn allowance. Stoke grows marks already on the enemy.
Successful closing phrase	Closeout refunds part of your paid mana. Backbeat stores counters after its damage.
Good-or-better Hold or Mash; full Good-or-better rally	Sustained Guard grants shield. For Ping-Pong, every return in the complete rally must qualify.

Combo and counters have different jobs

Combo measures your hit streak. **Counters** are stored charges that an action can spend. There is no separate Momentum meter in this system.

Automatic clears protect you but cannot earn execution rewards. They do not make the remaining phrase notes worth more. Empty or cancelled phrases do not qualify. Timing windows and lane inputs stay the same.

3. Turn rhythm into decisions

The new connections share resources across many actions. A passive does not need a single special partner to matter.

What you earn	Ways to use it
Counters Defense, Mirror Stance, Backbeat	Ordinary attacks can spend them for extra damage. Riposte cashes in more strongly. Improvisation uses them to strengthen healing, shield or a numerical buff.
Shield Shield Bash, healing overflow, special notes, reactions, mana overflow	Keep it for survival. Bedrock rewards melee while shield remains. Pressure Cast spends a portion on any damaging ability. Breakwater can choose its own shield conversion.
Mana Defense recovery, Siphon, Conservation, Closeout	Fund stronger actions. Tailwind and Arcane Thrift lower costs. Reservoir gives value to normal defense recovery that would overflow at full mana.
Enemy marks Burn, Static, Soaked, Cracked	Let them work, grow them with Wind or Stoke, or use another element to trigger a reaction. Burn can also pay for extra Cauterize healing.

Example: keep a shield or spend it?

With 60 shield, Pressure Cast can spend 20% - 12 shield - to add damage. Breakwater's Break option instead spends one third - 20 shield. Both happen before the rhythm chart, so poor timing can waste the investment. Breakwater never applies both conversions together.

Example: offense or stronger support?

With counters stored, you can attack now or use Improvisation on a support action. Two spent counters give +20% numerical support strength. Rally can then heal you and prepare the next attack, creating a decision across turns.

There is still a cost to every route

A shield spent on damage no longer protects you. Burn spent on healing is unavailable for a larger detonation. A support turn delays direct offense. These choices are what make the build strategic.

4. Elements and their marks

An element tells you which bonuses and reactions can apply. The ability's listed effect tells you whether it actually creates a mark.

Element	What it can set up
Fire / Burn	Burn deals damage at the start of enemy turns. Default: up to 5 stacks, lasting 3 enemy turns. New stacks refresh it. Flame Guard turns Perfect defense into Burn.
Water / Soaked	Soaked lowers the enemy's note damage by 20% for 2 enemy turns. Water also has healing and shields, when an ability explicitly provides them.
Lightning / Static	Static stores stacks for 3 enemy turns, normally up to 5. A Lightning hit at the cap discharges them. Lightning defense tools can zap incoming notes.
Earth / Cracked	Cracked makes the enemy take 20% more melee damage for 2 enemy turns. Earth also has lane protection and stagger tools.
Wind / no separate mark	Wind hits add stacks to existing Burn and Static and extend those marks, within the cast rules. It helps other elements rather than leaving a new mark.

A Fire ability does not automatically cause Burn

Fire Bolt deals Fire damage but does not list Burn. Ember Lash and Inferno do. Cauterize heals and does not cause Fire reactions. Check the effect instead of guessing from the icon or element.

Marks show under the enemy's health bar. Burn and Static show stack counts; other marks show time remaining. Enemy immunity, shortened duration and stack limits can change their value.

Mixed attacks resolve their damage types separately. Spellblade has Physical and Fire components: a Fire-resistant enemy reduces the Fire part, not the entire action. Enemy resistance never reduces your unrelated healing or self-buffs.

5. Reactions and board tricks

Use a second element on a marked enemy to change the payoff of your next action.

Reaction	Trigger and payoff
Conduct	Lightning on Soaked: zaps reach 1 extra note; Chain Spark arcs add a second hit at half strength. Soaked stays.
Steam	Fire on Soaked, or Water on Burn: a burst based on Burn strength and stacks, with a minimum based on the triggering hit. Consumes Burn and Soaked.
Overload	Fire on Static: discharge Static at double damage and consume it.
Wildfire	Wind on Burn: double Burn stacks up to their cap. Burn stays.
Mudlock	Water on Cracked, or Earth on Soaked: stagger the enemy and consume the marks.
Magnetize	Earth on Static: convert Static's discharge damage into a shield lasting 2 enemy turns.

Protective effects change the board in different ways

Zaps destroy approaching notes. Those notes deal no damage but give no combo, mana, judgement or counters. Holds, Mash notes and Ping-Pong shots cannot be zapped. The normal shared limit is 8 per enemy turn.

Stone Wall targets the busiest lane at each attack step and absorbs notes there. **Stagger** removes the next attack's last step. If there is only one step, it instead halves that step's note damage. Stagger cannot happen on two consecutive enemy turns.

Reactions are useful, but do not chain forever

Each reaction is limited to once per cast or enemy note. Reaction damage cannot trigger more reactions. Reaction Shelter rewards the first eligible reaction with shield; delayed Burn ticks and Aftershock do not produce another payout.

6. The four new tools

Each addition occupies one ability slot. Its options are choices inside the same ability.



Backbeat

Wind melee | 8 MP | cooldown 0

Deal damage and earn 1 counter from a 70% closing phrase, or 2 at 85%. Wind also feeds existing Burn and Static.

Use it to connect elemental setup, affordable offense and counter spending.



Breakwater

Water melee | 12 MP | cooldown 0

Guard: attack and gain shield. **Break:** trade up to one third of existing shield, max 30, for extra Water damage instead. Its Hold chart can earn Sustained Guard.

Choose survival or a stronger hit. Remaining shield still supports Bedrock.

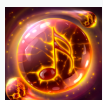


Cauterize

Fire healing spell | 18 MP | cooldown 2

Heal normally, or consume 1 enemy Burn stack for +30 healing before rhythm scaling. It works even with no Burn.

Choose between preserving Burn for Combust and spending one stack to recover.



Reprise

Defense / buff technique | 12 MP | cooldown 3

Choose a live player shield, ward or buff. A 70% chart extends it by 1 turn, once per application. It changes duration, so Improvisation does not spend counters on it.

Keep a useful effect alive instead of rebuilding it immediately.

Choices happen before you pay

Hold the ability lane as usual. When a choice panel appears, use mouse buttons, Up/Down + Enter, or D-pad + A. Backspace, B, or the Cancel button cancels without spending mana or starting cooldown. Escape pauses. Reprise with no eligible target costs nothing.

After commitment, resource spending happens before the chart. A weak performance does not refund paid mana, spent shield or consumed Burn.

7. Passives that connect the tools

All seven new passives have one level. They share counters, shield, marks and mana with the older content.

Passive	Plain-language effect
Improvisation	Pure support spends up to 2 counters: +10% healing, shield and numerical buff strength per charge. Reprise is excluded.
Sustained Guard	A completed Good-or-better Hold, Mash or full rally grants 8 shield, once per cast or whole enemy turn.
Pressure Cast	A damaging ability may spend 20% of existing shield, up to 20, for extra damage of its element. Breakwater uses only its own conversion.
Stoke	The first successful defense phrase adds 1 stack to Burn and Static already present. It does not create or refresh a mark.
Reaction Shelter	The first eligible elemental reaction grants 10 shield per cast or whole enemy turn.
Reservoir	Normal end-of-defense mana recovery that would overflow becomes shield, up to 10. Siphon and refunds do not feed it.
Closeout	A successful closing phrase returns 20% of actually paid MP, rounded down, up to 6.

Older passives still matter

Counter Preparation now rewards both Perfect defense and successful defense phrases within the same allowance. Second Wind can feed shield spending through overheal. Bedrock rewards shield you keep. Kindling improves Burn from existing sources, including Flame Guard. Tailwind helps a Wind action fund the next tool.

Unlimited ownership does not mean unlimited stacking

You can keep acquiring compatible passives, but each has level limits and shared caps. A passive whose last compatible ability is removed stays owned and becomes inactive.

8. Build and grow your loadout

Choose four actions that answer different problems. Then add passives that change the value of those actions.

Question	What to look for
How do I act when mana is low?	A dependable free action such as Strike or Siphon.
How do I survive the next enemy turn?	Healing, shield, reflection, weakened enemies or a specific board defense.
What is my main payoff?	Counters into Riposte, Burn into Combust, shield into damage, or a planned elemental reaction.
What changes my decision?	A tool that makes you choose between attack and support, keeping and spending shield, or preserving and consuming marks.

Role, delivery and element are separate

Role describes the job: damage, healing, defense, buff or resource recovery. **Delivery** describes how it is used: melee, spell, ranged or technique. **Element** describes its damage or named effect. These labels decide which passives apply.

For example, Thunder Clap deals Lightning damage but is a technique, not a spell. Arcane Thrift therefore does not discount it. Spellblade is both melee and a spell, so it can connect both kinds of compatible bonuses.

Sequence by need, not a rigid rotation

Rally can prepare a later attack through its own buff and Follow-Through. Versatility rewards changing action roles. But if you urgently need healing, take the useful action rather than chasing a bonus.

A shield or buff has a turn limit; counters fade if left idle. Look at the remaining time before deciding to prepare more. The strongest available attack is not always the best action this turn.

9. Rewards, inventory and runs

Your equipped tools, reserve abilities, upgrades and passive collection belong to the current run.

Reward type	What it changes
New ability	Add a new tool. With four occupied slots, replace an equipped action or keep the new one in reserve.
Ability upgrade	Improve one particular ability instance. It moves with that ability into another slot or reserve.
Passive	Add an automatic effect or level an existing passive, up to its maximum. It uses no active slot.

Use the Resonance Archive

Press **Tab** to inspect the four equipped abilities, reserves and passive collection. Select an ability and then a slot to swap it. X unequips. During combat, the archive is for inspection; rearrange outside battle. Details explain levels, effects and inactive requirements.

At rewards, select with arrows, W/S, gamepad, mouse or a number key, then confirm with Enter or **Attune**. A click selects rather than immediately claiming. Review replacement consequences before choosing. The same saved offer cannot be claimed twice.

Travel and reset

Ordinary area travel keeps the character's current health, mana and run build. Starting a new run in Dungeon uses Blank Slate and resets progression. Returning to the main menu ends the run; reloading the current area retains it. A durable game save is a separate integration, not something to assume from the build panel's save option.

Trying presets during development

In the Editor or a Development Build, F11 opens the Run Build panel. Choose a preset on its Build tab and use the restart-battle control if a fight is already running. The Combat tab helps explain what produced a bonus.

Builds: new rhythm connections

Each preset uses exactly four abilities. Listed passives are a starting collection, not an ownership limit.

Improvising Duelist

Four abilities: Siphon, Riposte, Mirror Stance, Rally

Starting passives: Counter Preparation, Improvisation, Deflection, Follow-Through

How to play: Earn counters during defense. Use Mirror Stance to reflect and prepare charges. Spend them on Riposte when you can attack, or on Rally when you need recovery and setup. Siphon restores mana.

Decision and trade-off: Counters spent on support are unavailable for the next Riposte. Reflection still asks you to defend well.

Useful later rewards: Closeout or Conservation supports mana; Blade Discipline strengthens melee.

Armored Spellcaster

Four abilities: Siphon, Shield Bash, Fire Bolt, Rally

Starting passives: Second Wind, Pressure Cast, Closeout, Reservoir

How to play: Shield Bash builds protection while attacking. Rally can overheal into more shield. Decide whether Fire Bolt should spend some protection for damage. Closing phrases recover part of paid mana.

Decision and trade-off: Spending shield makes the next defense less forgiving. This build has Fire damage but no listed Burn source.

Useful later rewards: Bedrock rewards keeping shield; Sustained Guard adds value to suitable charts.

Builds: new rhythm connections (continued)

Each preset uses exactly four abilities. Listed passives are a starting collection, not an ownership limit.

Living Furnace

Four abilities: Strike, Flame Guard, Cauterize, Combust

Starting passives: Stoke, Pyre Keeper, Kindling, Second Wind

How to play: Flame Guard turns Perfect defense into Burn. Stoke grows existing stacks. Keep Burn for a stronger Combust or use one stack to improve Cauterize. Overheal becomes protection.

Decision and trade-off: Combust consumes the setup. Healing from Burn trades away some future detonation damage. Burn immunity changes the plan.

Useful later rewards: Pressure Cast connects shield to attack damage; Closeout supports paid turns.

Breakwater Knight

Four abilities: Siphon, Breakwater, Quake Slam, Reprise

Starting passives: Bedrock, Sustained Guard, Aftershock, Reaction Shelter

How to play: Complete Holds for shield. Breakwater Guard supplies more; Break converts a portion into damage. Quake Slam sets Cracked, so a later Water hit can Mudlock. Reprise preserves a useful shield or buff.

Decision and trade-off: Spending shield weakens Bedrock and protection. Reprise uses a whole action. Boss stagger limits reduce repeated control.

Useful later rewards: Reservoir adds another shield source; Closeout helps paid actions.

Builds: new rhythm connections (continued)

Each preset uses exactly four abilities. Listed passives are a starting collection, not an ownership limit.

Storm Conductor

Four abilities: Siphon, Backbeat, Chain Spark, Undertow

Starting passives: Counter Preparation, Capacitor, Catalyst, Reaction Shelter

How to play: Undertow sets Soaked. Chain Spark uses it for Conduct and builds Static. Backbeat feeds existing marks and earns counters. Ordinary damaging actions can cash those charges in.

Decision and trade-off: Perfects matter for Chain Spark's arcs. This preset has no healing ability, so defense and shield rewards matter.

Useful later rewards: Tailwind can discount the next action; add Improvisation only after equipping support.

Builds: existing presets

These remain useful starting points and can acquire the new passives whenever their requirements fit.

Mirror Guard

Abilities: Strike, Riposte, Mirror Stance, Mend

Passives: Counter Preparation, Deflection

Earn counters through accurate defense, use Mirror Stance for reflection, then choose Riposte or recovery. Counter charges fade if unused.

Trade-off: Needs accurate defense; charges fade if unused

Pyromancer

Abilities: Strike, Fire Bolt, Inferno, Focus

Passives: Glass Heart, Mana Surge, Pyromancy, Conservation

Focus prepares a large spell. Inferno qualifies for Mana Surge at its normal paid cost. Use well-played Strike with Conservation to save mana. Glass Heart trades away survivability.

Trade-off: 650 max HP; Inferno competes with survival

Bulwark

Abilities: Shield Bash, Strike, Bulwark, Mend

Passives: Fortitude, Iron Skin, Second Wind, Tidal Healing

Shield Bash attacks while protecting. Bulwark lowers pressure. Mend plus Second Wind turns excess healing into shield. You survive longer but face more enemy sequences.

Trade-off: Low damage, long fights; shields cap and expire

Builds: existing presets (continued)

These remain useful starting points and can acquire the new passives whenever their requirements fit.

Wanderer

Abilities: Strike (+Searing Edge), Spellblade, Rally, Frost Lance

Passives: Versatility, Follow-Through, Measured Execution, Arcane Thrift

Switch between support and damage to benefit from role sequencing. Rally prepares attacks. Searing Edge adds Fire to Strike; Frost Lance gives a different element against resistance.

Trade-off: Lower peaks; needs sequencing

Riposte Mage

Abilities: Strike, Riposte (+Honed Riposte), Fire Bolt (+Quickcast), Siphon

Passives: Counter Preparation, Glass Heart

Pick counter damage or a spell according to the enemy. Two free attacks help conserve mana, but Glass Heart still reduces HP. Dedicated upgrades stay with their individual abilities.

Trade-off: Keeps both styles' costs: 650 HP and charges earned through accurate defense

Blank Slate

Abilities: Strike, Mend

Passives: -

Start with Strike and Mend. Fill the two open slots through rewards, then choose passives around the strategy you are actually developing.

Trade-off: Grow a build through rewards

Builds: existing presets (continued)

These remain useful starting points and can acquire the new passives whenever their requirements fit.

Storm Caller

Abilities: Strike, Chain Spark, Storm Ward, Undertow

Passives: Conductor, Capacitor, Catalyst

Use Undertow for Soaked, then Lightning for Conduct. Storm Ward and Conductor protect through zaps. Cleared notes do not earn more precision resources.

Trade-off: Needs Perfects on both turns; zaps are capped per turn

Pyre Warden

Abilities: Strike, Ember Lash, Flame Guard, Undertow (reserve: Combust)

Passives: Pyre Keeper, Catalyst

Build Burn through Ember Lash and Flame Guard. Undertow cashes it into Steam. Combust is in reserve: swap it in outside combat if you prefer that payoff.

Trade-off: Burn is slow until detonated; Steam uses up both marks

Tidecaller

Abilities: Strike, Undertow, Tidal Veil, Rain Dance

Passives: Riptide, Purist, Unyielding

Keep a Water-only elemental loadout for Purist. Rain Dance heals over several turns, Tidal Veil protects, and Riptide turns Water overheal into damage.

Trade-off: Slow damage; Purist breaks with a second element

Builds: existing presets (continued)

These remain useful starting points and can acquire the new passives whenever their requirements fit.

Stonewarden

Abilities: Tremor, Quake Slam, Stone Wall, Cyclone (reserve: Gale Step)

Passives: Aftershock, Tailwind, Attunement, Bedrock

Quake Slam and Aftershock provide delayed pressure. Stone Wall protects one lane. Cyclone supports marks and Tailwind discounts. Gale Step starts in reserve; use cooldown-aware planning.

Trade-off: Bosses resist stagger after their limit; the wall covers one lane

Ability catalog / 1

MP is the listed mana cost before discounts and upgrades. Cooldown counts player-turn updates. Power is the starting base value, not guaranteed final damage.

The first four are the legacy fallback loadout. They have no delivery tags, so delivery-specific passives do not apply to them. Normal run content follows after those four.



Basic Attack

Physical | 0 MP | cooldown 0 | power 22 | legacy Basic Attack
Damage x 1



Flamethrower

Fire | 20 MP | cooldown 0 | power 50 | legacy Special Attack
Fire damage x 1



Heal

- | 30 MP | cooldown 2 | power 150 | legacy Healing
Heal x 1 (default for Healing type)



Death Faith

- | 25 MP | cooldown 4 | power 0 | legacy Defensive
Ward the used lane: Bad and Miss deal no damage for 3 enemy turns (+1 turn at 90%+ performance); fails below 25%



Strike

Physical | 0 MP | cooldown 0 | power 22 | Damage; Melee
Damage x 1



Siphon

Physical | 0 MP | cooldown 0 | power 13 | Damage, Resource; Melee
Damage x 1; restores 8 MP x performance

Ability catalog / 2

MP is the listed mana cost before discounts and upgrades. Cooldown counts player-turn updates. Power is the starting base value, not guaranteed final damage.



Shield Bash

Physical | 6 MP | cooldown 0 | power 18 | Damage, Defense; Melee
Damage x 1; shield x 2 power (about 35) for 2 enemy turns



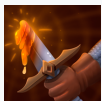
Riposte

Physical | 8 MP | cooldown 0 | power 26 | Damage; Melee, Technique
Damage x 1; spends up to 5 counter charges, +30% damage each



Focus

- | 10 MP | cooldown 2 | power 0 | Buff; Technique
Next attack +60% x performance, lasts 2 player turns



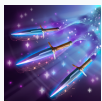
Spellblade

Fire | 12 MP | cooldown 0 | power 35 | Damage; Melee, Spell
Physical x 0.6 + Fire x 0.6, resolved as separate components



Thunder Clap

Lightning | 14 MP | cooldown 0 | power 40 | Damage; Technique
Lightning damage x 1 (not a spell)

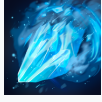


Mirror Stance

- | 15 MP | cooldown 3 | power 0 | Buff, Defense; Technique
2 enemy turns: Perfect defense reflects 60% x performance of the note's damage (Good half), max 60 per turn; +1 counter charge (+2 at 85%+)

Ability catalog / 3

MP is the listed mana cost before discounts and upgrades. Cooldown counts player-turn updates. Power is the starting base value, not guaranteed final damage.



Frost Lance

Water | 16 MP | cooldown 0 | power 44 | Damage; Spell, Ranged
Water damage x 1



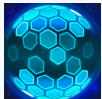
Rally

- | 18 MP | cooldown 2 | power 75 | Healing, Buff; Spell
Heal x 1; next attack +30% x performance for 2 player turns



Fire Bolt

Fire | 20 MP | cooldown 0 | power 53 | Damage; Spell, Ranged
Fire damage x 1



Bulwark

- | 20 MP | cooldown 3 | power 60 | Defense; Technique
Take 35% less note damage for 2 enemy turns; shield x 1 (60) for 2 enemy turns



Mend

Water | 25 MP | cooldown 2 | power 135 | Healing; Spell
Water-attributed heal x 1



Inferno

Fire | 45 MP | cooldown 2 | power 99 | Damage; Spell
Fire damage x 1; Burn: about 15 x performance fire damage at each enemy turn start, 3 ticks

Ability catalog / 4

MP is the listed mana cost before discounts and upgrades. Cooldown counts player-turn updates. Power is the starting base value, not guaranteed final damage.



Ember Lash

Fire | 10 MP | cooldown 0 | power 24 | Damage; Melee
Damage x 1; +1 Burn stack per Perfect in its chart (max 3), 4 damage per stack per tick



Flame Guard

Fire | 20 MP | cooldown 2 | power 44 | Defense; Technique
2 enemy turns: each Perfect block adds 1 Burn stack (about 4 per stack per tick), max 5 per turn



Combust

Fire | 35 MP | cooldown 2 | power 22 | Damage; Spell
Damage x 0.5; removes Burn and deals its remaining damage x 1.5 at once



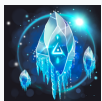
Undertow

Water | 20 MP | cooldown 0 | power 35 | Damage; Spell
Water damage x 1; Soaked for 2 turns



Tidal Veil

Water | 25 MP | cooldown 2 | power 18 | Defense; Spell
Shield x 1.2 (about 22) for 2 enemy turns; heals 50% of it when it breaks



Rain Dance

Water | 20 MP | cooldown 3 | power 135 | Healing; Spell
Heal x 1.2 spread over 3 player turns (about 54 each), Water healing

Ability catalog / 5

MP is the listed mana cost before discounts and upgrades. Cooldown counts player-turn updates. Power is the starting base value, not guaranteed final damage.



Chain Spark

Lightning | 15 MP | cooldown 0 | power 26 | Damage; Spell
Damage x 1; each Perfect in its chart fires an arc right away (5 Lightning) and adds 1 Static (discharge 5 per stack)



Storm Ward

Lightning | 20 MP | cooldown 3 | power 44 | Defense; Spell
2 enemy turns: each Perfect block zaps the next 2 notes (about 4 Lightning each), max 6 per turn



Quake Slam

Earth | 20 MP | cooldown 2 | power 53 | Damage; Melee
Earth damage x 1; Cracked for 2 turns. Includes a Hold chart



Stone Wall

Earth | 20 MP | cooldown 3 | power 0 | Defense; Technique
Walls the busiest lane: absorbs the next 4 notes there, up to 2 enemy turns



Tremor

Earth | 0 MP | cooldown 2 | power 11 | Damage; Technique
Earth damage x 1; stagger (needs 50%+ chart performance)



Gale Step

Wind | 0 MP | cooldown 2 | power 13 | Damage, Defense; Technique
Wind damage x 1; dodge the first Miss of the next enemy turn

Ability catalog / 6

MP is the listed mana cost before discounts and upgrades. Cooldown counts player-turn updates. Power is the starting base value, not guaranteed final damage.



Cyclone

Wind | 30 MP | cooldown 2 | power 48 | Damage; Spell
Wind damage x 1 as 6 separate hits (each hit feeds the marks)



Backbeat

Wind | 8 MP | cooldown 0 | power 18 | damage; melee
Wind melee attack, power 18. Closing phrase: 1 counter at 70%, 2 at 85%, gained after damage.



Breakwater

Water | 12 MP | cooldown 0 | power 26 | damage / defense; melee
Water melee attack, power 26. **Guard:** also shield x 0.7. **Break:** instead spend one third of existing shield, max 30, for extra Water damage.



Cauterize

Fire | 18 MP | cooldown 2 | power 75 | healing; spell
Fire healing, power 75. Optionally consume one enemy Burn stack for +30 healing before rhythm scaling.



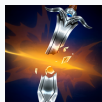
Reprise

No element | 12 MP | cooldown 3 | power 0 | buff / defense; technique
Choose a live player shield, ward or buff. At 70% chart accuracy, extend it one turn, once per application.

Damage, healing and shield scale with rhythm performance. Most buffs, shields and statuses fail below 25%; Tremor needs 50% for stagger and Reprise needs 70% for extension.

Passive catalog / 1

Values start at level 1. A bracketed +value is added for each extra level. Duplicate passive rewards level it up to its maximum.

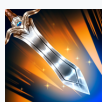


Counter Preparation

Max level 3 | Needs: -

Each Perfect defense or completed 70%+ defense phrase stores 1 charge. Both fill the same allowance. Attacks without their own spender use up to 3 for +10% each

Limit: 2 charges per enemy turn (+1); 5 stored; fade after 2 idle player turns

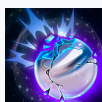


Deflection

Max level 3 | Needs: -

Perfect defense reflects 30% (+10%) of the note's damage as physical damage

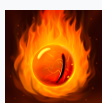
Limit: 40 (+15) per enemy turn



Mirror Mastery

Max level 2 | Needs: A buff ability

Reflect buffs last +1 enemy turn and are 15% (+15%) stronger

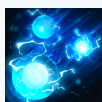


Glass Heart

Max level 2 | Needs: A spell damage ability

-35% max HP; +30% (+15%) spell damage

Limit: Exclusive with Fortitude

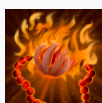


Mana Surge

Max level 3 | Needs: -

Attacks that paid 30+ MP deal +20% (+10%) damage

Limit: Uses paid cost, never refunds

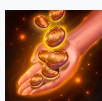


Pyromancy

Max level 3 | Needs: A fire component

Fire damage components +25% (+10%)

Limit: Fire bonuses share a +60% cap



Conservation

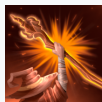
Max level 3 | Needs: -

Attacks paying 8 MP or less, played at 60%+, restore 5 (+3) MP

Limit: Once per cast

Passive catalog / 2

Values start at level 1. A bracketed +value is added for each extra level. Duplicate passive rewards level it up to its maximum.



Kindling

Max level 2 | Needs: A status ability

Burn gets +1 tick and +25% (+15%) damage per tick



Fortitude

Max level 3 | Needs: -

+30% (+10%) max HP

Limit: Exclusive with Glass Heart

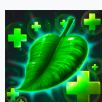


Iron Skin

Max level 3 | Needs: -

Note damage -25% (+5%)

Limit: Prevents at most 40 (+15) per enemy turn

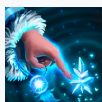


Second Wind

Max level 3 | Needs: A healing ability

50% (+15%) of overheal becomes shield for 2 enemy turns

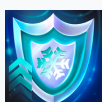
Limit: Shared shield cap: 30% max HP



Tidal Healing

Max level 3 | Needs: A water heal

Water-attributed healing +25% (+10%)



Steady Guard

Max level 3 | Needs: -

An enemy turn with 3 or fewer misses grants a 30 (+15) shield for 1 enemy turn

Limit: Once per enemy turn; needs 1+ note and an uninterrupted turn



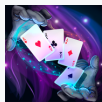
Bastion

Max level 2 | Needs: A buff ability

Damage-reduction buffs last +1 enemy turn

Passive catalog / 3

Values start at level 1. A bracketed +value is added for each extra level. Duplicate passive rewards level it up to its maximum.

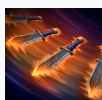


Versatility

Max level 3 | Needs: -

An action whose role differs from the previous one: +20% (+5%) damage, healing and shield

Limit: Not on the first action



Follow-Through

Max level 3 | Needs: -

A non-damage buff / heal / defense action at 50%+ gives the next attack +25% (+10%)

Limit: One pending bonus; 2 player turns

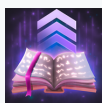


Measured Execution

Max level 3 | Needs: A damage ability

+15% (+5%) damage when the chart is played at 85%+

Limit: Once per cast; cancelled or empty charts don't count

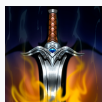


Arcane Thrift

Max level 3 | Needs: A spell

Spells cost 20% (+5%) less mana

Limit: Minimum 1 MP

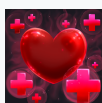


Blade Discipline

Max level 3 | Needs: A melee damage ability

Melee damage +20% (+10%)

Limit: Melee bonuses share a +60% cap



Vitality

Max level 5 | Needs: -

+5% (+5%) max HP

Limit: Offered only when too few other rewards are eligible



Pyre Keeper

Max level 3 | Needs: A Fire ability

Burn max stacks +2 (+1); Burn damage +10% (+10%)

Passive catalog / 4

Values start at level 1. A bracketed +value is added for each extra level. Duplicate passive rewards level it up to its maximum.



Conductor

Max level 3 | Needs: A Lightning ability

The first 3 (+1) Perfects each enemy turn zap 1 note (8 +4 Lightning)

Limit: Shares the per-turn zap limit



Capacitor

Max level 3 | Needs: A Lightning ability

Static max stacks +3 (+1); discharge +50% (+25%)



Riptide

Max level 3 | Needs: A Water heal

50% (+25%) of Water overheal hits the enemy as Water damage (can react)

Limit: Secondary-effect budget per cast

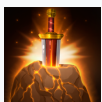


Bedrock

Max level 3 | Needs: A melee damage ability

While shielded, melee attacks deal +10% (+5%) of the shield as damage

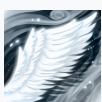
Limit: Once per cast



Aftershock

Max level 3 | Needs: An Earth ability

Earth abilities hit again for 30% (+10%) of their damage at the next enemy turn start

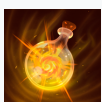


Tailwind

Max level 3 | Needs: A Wind ability

After a Wind ability, the next ability costs 30% (+10%) less MP

Limit: One pending discount



Catalyst

Max level 3 | Needs: Two different elements equipped

Reactions +25% (+10%); the first reaction each battle keeps its marks

Passive catalog / 5

Values start at level 1. A bracketed +value is added for each extra level. Duplicate passive rewards level it up to its maximum.



Attunement

Max level 3 | Needs: An elemental ability
+4% (+2%) elemental damage per different element used this battle
Limit: Max 5 elements; exclusive with Purist



Purist

Max level 3 | Needs: Every equipped elemental ability shares one element (physical ones don't count)
That element's damage +15% (+5%); its marks last +1 turn
Limit: Exclusive with Attunement



Unyielding

Max level 1 | Needs: -
Once per battle, a lethal hit leaves you at 1 HP
Limit: Once per battle



Improvisation

Max level 1 | New rhythm connection
Pure support spends up to 2 counters for +10% healing, shield and numerical buff strength each.



Sustained Guard

Max level 1 | New rhythm connection
Complete a Hold, Mash or full Good-or-better rally for 8 shield, once per cast/whole enemy turn.



Pressure Cast

Max level 1 | New rhythm connection
Any damaging ability can optionally spend 20% of existing shield, max 20, for extra damage of its element.



Stoke

Max level 1 | New rhythm connection
First successful defense phrase per enemy turn adds 1 existing Burn and Static stack. No new mark, refresh or reaction.

Passive catalog / 6

Values start at level 1. A bracketed +value is added for each extra level. Duplicate passive rewards level it up to its maximum.



Reaction Shelter

Max level 1 | New rhythm connection

First elemental reaction per cast/whole enemy turn gives 10 shield.



Reservoir

Max level 1 | New rhythm connection

Normal end-of-defense mana overflow becomes shield, max 10.



Closeout

Max level 1 | New rhythm connection

Successful closing phrase restores 20% of actually paid MP, rounded down, max 6.

Ability upgrades

An upgrade attaches to one ability instance, follows it between slots and reserve, and can be taken once by that instance.

Upgrade	Attaches to	Change
Honed Riposte	Riposte	+25% power
Lasting Mirror	Mirror Stance	Cooldown -1 (3 -> 2)
Quickcast	Fire Bolt	Cost -5 MP (20 -> 15)
Ember Heart	Inferno	Cooldown -1 (2 -> 1), cost +5 MP (45 -> 50)
Overflowing Mend	Mend	+20% power
Searing Edge	Strike	Adds a separate Fire damage component x 0.4
Ignite	Spellblade	Adds Burn (fire, x 0.08 power per tick, 2 ticks); cost +3 MP
Heavy Shield	Shield Bash	+30% power (damage and shield), cost +2 MP
Honed Technique	Any melee damage ability	+15% power

An upgrade is not a global passive

Quickcast improves its Fire Bolt instance. Moving Fire Bolt keeps that improvement. Replacing it with an unrelated spell does not transfer Quickcast to the replacement.

Shared limits and enemy matchups

These boundaries keep the connections useful without letting a single reward loop run forever.

Rule	Practical meaning
Shield capacity	Total shield cannot exceed 30% of maximum HP. Sustained Guard, Reaction Shelter and Reservoir share a smaller 20-shield reward budget per cast or whole enemy turn.
Mana refunds	Conservation and Closeout together restore at most 12 MP per cast. Siphon's own mana effect is separate. Closeout uses actual payment, so discounts reduce its refund.
Discounts	Combined passive and live discounts cannot remove more than 60% of a positive upgraded listed cost. A paid spell retains a minimum cost.
Counters	Normally 5 stored. Counter Preparation earns 2 per enemy turn at level 1, +1 per extra level, shared between its Perfect and phrase triggers. Counters expire after 2 idle player turns.
Extra duration	Player effects gain at most 2 extra turns total. Reprise adds 1 once per application and shares this allowance with other duration bonuses.
Damage bonuses	Bonuses add within their group, then groups multiply. Each group is capped at +200%; the total multiplier before enemy affinity is capped at x4.

Match the enemy, not just your preset

The original enemies have neutral damage affinities. Test profiles include Fire-resistant (Fire x0.5, Water x1.5), Armored (Physical x0.6, Lightning x1.5, Water x1.25), Burn-immune, Frail, and a Boss with 1 stagger per battle and 3 zaps per enemy turn.

Shield spending cannot trigger Tidal Veil's break-heal and removes the spent share of future break-healing. Follow-up damage and refunds are not new casts. They cannot collect another closing-phrase reward.

Quick glossary and source notes

Use this page when a rule name feels more complicated than the idea behind it.

Term	Meaning
MP / mana	The resource you pay to use an ability.
Performance	The average quality of the ability's rhythm judgements.
Phrase	One musical bar of authored notes; normally successful at 70% or better.
Pure support	A heal, buff or defense action that does not deal damage.
Overheal	Healing left over after you have reached full health.
Mark	A temporary effect on the enemy, such as Burn or Soaked.
Affinity	The enemy's multiplier for a particular damage type.
Cast / whole enemy turn	One ability use / the enemy's entire sequence, including all its attack steps.
Reserve	An owned ability outside your four equipped slots.
Ward	Protection with a specific rule, such as protecting one lane.

Documentation used

docs/design/abilities-and-passives.md

Complete content values, upgrades, original presets and enemy profiles.

docs/design/rhythm-synergy.md

Latest phrase rewards, four new abilities, seven new passives, five builds and shared limits.

docs/design/run-resonance-architecture.md

Core combat, four-slot build model, reward rules and design constraints.

docs/design/run-resonance-implementation.md

How to inspect and try builds; runtime behavior and development tools.

docs/design/artifact-interface.md

Current inventory and reward interactions.

docs/design/scene-loading.md

Travel, new-run starts and reset behavior.

Prepared 2 October 2026. This guide summarizes the current local documentation rather than reproducing implementation code. The latest rhythm-synergy and interface notes take precedence over older testing notes. Costs, powers, caps and sample builds are playtesting values and can change with tuning.